

Laravel Book File Upload

Step-by-step guide for implementing book uploads with cover image and PDF file in Laravel.

Step 1 — Run Migration

Your books migration is already set up with `cover_image` and `file_path` columns. Just run:

```
php artisan migrate:fresh
```

Step 2 — Create Model and Controller

Run this command to generate both at once:

```
php artisan make:model Book
php artisan make:controller BookController --resource
```

Step 3 — Setup Model Fillable

Open `app/Models/Book.php` and add the fillable fields:

```
protected $fillable = [
    'user_id', 'title', 'author', 'cover_image',
    'file_path', 'description', 'access_type',
    'price', 'status', 'rejection_reason'
];
```

Step 4 — Add Route

In `web.php`, add the resource route with auth middleware:

```
Route::resource('/books', BookController::class)->middleware('auth');
```

Step 5 — Create the Upload Form (`create.blade.php`)

Important: The form must have `enctype='multipart/form-data'` for file uploads to work.

```
<form method='POST' action='/books' enctype='multipart/form-data'>
    @csrf

    <!-- Title -->
    <input name='title' type='text'>

    <!-- Author -->
    <input name='author' type='text'>
```

```

<!-- Access Type -->
<select name='access_type'>
    <option value='free'>Free</option>
    <option value='paid'>Paid</option>
</select>

<!-- Cover Image - JPG/JPEG only -->
<input type='file' name='cover_image' accept='.jpg,.jpeg'>

<!-- PDF File -->
<input type='file' name='file_path' accept='.pdf'>

<button type='submit'>Upload</button>
</form>

```

Step 6 — Controller store() Method

This is where the file gets saved. Laravel handles the upload automatically:

```

public function store() {
    $attributes = request()->validate([
        'title' => ['required'],
        'author' => ['required'],
        'description' => ['nullable'],
        'access_type' => ['required'],
        'price' => ['nullable', 'numeric'],
        'cover_image' => ['required', 'image', 'mimes:jpg,jpeg', 'max:2048'],
        'file_path' => ['required', 'mimes:pdf', 'max:10240'],
    ]);

    // Save cover image to public/covers
    $attributes['cover_image'] = request()->file('cover_image')
        ->store('covers', 'public');

    // Save PDF to public/uploads
    $attributes['file_path'] = request()->file('file_path')
        ->store('uploads', 'public');

    $attributes['user_id'] = auth()->id();
    $attributes['status'] = 'pending';

    Book::create($attributes);
    return redirect('/books');
}

```

Step 7 — Run Storage Link (once only!)

Run this command once in your terminal. This creates a link so uploaded files are accessible in the browser:

```
php artisan storage:link
```

You only need to run this once. After this, files in `storage/app/public/` will be accessible via `/storage/` in the browser.

Step 8 — Display Files in Blade

Use `asset('storage/...')` to display the files in your blade views:

```
<!-- Display cover image -->


<!-- Link to download PDF -->
<a href="{ asset('storage/' . $book->file_path) }}">Download PDF</a>
```

Simple Mental Model

1. User picks a file on the form
2. `enctype='multipart/form-data'` sends the file to Laravel
3. `->store('covers', 'public')` saves file to `storage/app/public/covers/`
4. Returns path `'covers/filename.jpg'` which gets saved in the database
5. `asset('storage/' . $book->cover_image)` displays it in the browser

Key things to remember: `enctype` on the form and `storage:link` in the terminal!